

Backup & Business Continuity Checklist

Confirm whether your business can recover from ransomware, deletion, outage or device loss.

PURPOSE

Backups are not the same as recoverability

This checklist helps determine whether a business can actually recover from ransomware, accidental deletion, system failure, cloud account compromise or a site-level outage.

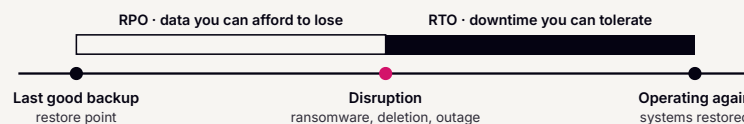
HOW TO USE IT

Nine checks, one honest answer each

- 1 Work through the checks with whoever runs your backups and your key systems.
- 2 Mark **Yes**, **No** or **Unknown** for each. Treat Unknown as an area to review, not a pass.
- 3 Write the owner, and any evidence such as the date of the last restore test, on the notes line.
- 4 Use the result with the next step on the last page.

TERMS

The two targets that matter



RPO and RTO on one timeline.

RTO

Recovery Time Objective: how long the business can tolerate downtime.

RPO

Recovery Point Objective: how much data the business can afford to lose.

BCDR

Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery: the strategy for keeping the business operating during disruption.

01 Backup & BCDR review

What is protected

4 CHECKS

C01 CRITICAL DATA
Do you know which systems and files must be recovered first? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

C02 ENDPOINT BACKUP
Are user devices backed up where business data exists locally? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

C03 CLOUD DATA
Are Microsoft 365, Google Workspace or other cloud data sources backed up separately? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

C04 SERVERS AND SYSTEMS
Are business-critical systems backed up with documented retention? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

Whether it can be recovered

2 CHECKS

C05 RECOVERY TESTING
Has a restore been tested in the last 90 days? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

C06 RANSOMWARE READINESS
Are backups protected from deletion or encryption by compromised accounts? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

How fast, and how much

2 CHECKS

C07 RECOVERY TIME (RTO)
Do you know how long the business can be down before real damage occurs? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

C08

RECOVERY POINT (RPO)

Do you know how much data loss is acceptable?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

Who owns recovery

1 CHECK

C09

DOCUMENTATION

Is the recovery process documented and assigned to responsible parties?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

02

Notes and follow-ups

OWNERS, EVIDENCE, DATES

NEXT STEP

Request a Backup & BCDR review

If restore testing, cloud backup or recovery ownership is unclear, request a Backup & Business Continuity review before assuming the business is protected.

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Educational checklist. It does not assess or certify any environment. This document names no customers and makes no vendor-specific claims.